LENA VARGA-HOLM

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER | DATA PLATFORM

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PROFILE

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building and operating production data platforms and cloud data warehouses across logistics, e-commerce and payments. Strong hands-on experience with Python, SQL, Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Snowflake and AWS, including large-scale batch and streaming pipelines, dimensional data modelling, data quality and data contracts. Focused on reliable, well-tested platforms and reusable engineering practices; contributor to open-source tooling and speaker on data contracts.

CORE SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data platforms and engineering: Airflow, dbt, PySpark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations
Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions, CI/CD
Data modelling and quality: Dimensional modelling, data contracts, JSON Schema, pipeline testing, data quality
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace) *03/2022–Present*

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the central data platform, operating approximately 140 Airflow DAGs that load data from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated warehouse transformations from stored procedures to dbt, delivering 420+ models with tests; reduced nightly build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 50 minutes.
- Introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from approximately 9 to 2 per month.
- Designed and built a Kafka-based shipment-event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing approximately 30 million events per day with under 2-minute p95 end-to-end latency; added dead-letter and replay tooling.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from Postgres with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced Snowflake spend from approximately $38K to $24K per month through warehouse sizing, auto-suspend and removal of unused tables.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation (one week in six); mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay (payments startup) *09/2019–02/2022*

- Built PySpark batch jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile bank settlement files against internal ledgers, processing approximately 1.2 TB of raw S3 files daily.
- Delivered reconciliation improvements that reduced finance team's manual work from approximately three days to four hours per month-end.
- Designed a Redshift star-schema warehouse with 30+ fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Implemented Great Expectations checks on critical finance tables.
- Developed an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, adopted by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | Adria Retail Group *06/2017–08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL processes for an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron, making data loads easier to debug and change.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across 40+ stores.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE & COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTIONS

- Contributed two merged pull requests to an Airflow provider package for a SaaS CRM API, fixing a pagination bug and adding tests (Python, pytest, 2023).
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup (2024).
- Teach beginner SQL at a local women-in-tech meetup, approximately four evenings per year since 2021.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science, Data Science track | Northgate Technical University *2017*
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate *May 2024*

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native) | English (C1) | German (B1)